To Name, To Know- REROUTE

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45622336.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warnings:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora, Lonnie, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Adora goes full Revenant, Weird Runestone headcanons, Weird Heart of Etheria Headcanons, Angst, Hurt No Comfort, No editors we die with courage, Lonnie's gonna develop a complex at this rate, Adora's is practially older than she is, Narrative fun with tenses

Language:
English

Series:
Part 5 of Witch's Apprentice AU

Stats:
Published: 2023-03-09 Words: 2,531 Chapters: 1/1

To Name, To Know- REROUTE

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45622336.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warnings:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora, Lonnie, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Adora goes full Revenant, Weird Runestone headcanons, Weird Heart of Etheria Headcanons, Angst, Hurt No Comfort, No editors we die with courage, Lonnie's gonna develop a complex at this rate, Adora's is practially older than she is, Narrative fun with tenses

Language:
English

Series:
Part 5 of Witch's Apprentice AU

Stats:
Published: 2023-03-09 Words: 2,531 Chapters: 1/1

To Name, To Know- REROUTE

by genVicron

Summary

Adora has always trusted easily.

She has to, things break so easily in her hands.

The Heart cuts out the middleman.

Notes

Today's shit gets real mix is Nightmare Reg.

See the end of the work for more notes

Memories come slowly, steadily. Names, match to faces, match to past.

She watches Lonnie- *they're friends, but sparring with Lonnie was an exercise in paranoia. Somebody told her real fights weren't fair when she was little and she took it to heart like nobody else-* enter through the hangar, shoulders hunched.

The Sword is soothing the Garnet, leaving Adora more room to *think.* Mistress- don't Name her, not yet, not strong enough yet- hasn't noticed, the power flows to her the same.

Captain Scorpia steps out after Lonnie, the Sword on her hip. Where is Catra? They have the Sword, they should have Catra. Irrelevant, the Sword murmurs. Adora doesn't like that answer, but even with its help, she doesn't know if she'll keep thinking if she gets angry or afraid.

She's so tired. Hard to be tired when the Garnet hurt so much. So tired is good.

Most days, Lonnie thanked her lucky alignment that Scorpia was her Captain. Today was not one of those days. After seeing Catra- attacking them with blank, empty eyes, practically a corpse even before that poor idiot stabbed her- Lonnie didn't want to do anything but curl up and sleep off the adrenaline rush.

If she grabbed Rogelio and Kyle to cover for noise, that was her business and no one else's.

Instead, she was stuck with the delivery team because Scorpia had to be on it, and she'd noticed that Lonnie was shaken, so she had to come along so her Captain could keep an eye on her.

Instead, Lonnie had to hand over another treasure to the witch that had killed Adora, the one who *did this* to them. Maybe this time she'd have the nerve to take a swing at her. Probably not, Lonnie knew when she was outmatched, and Shadow Weaver would probably just enjoy what came next.

The closer the Sword gets, the stronger it becomes in the Garnet. Adora can almost feel things for herself again. Something she thinks is anticipation is thrumming through her, alongside a low ache. Fear, maybe? They are almost here, and she still doesn't see Catra.

Why doesn't she see Catra?

Mistress is growing impatient, hands stiff, sparks across her fingers- *"We're sorry, it won't happen again, right Catra?"*- It always happened again; Adora knows how Mistress' mind works now, feels it flow over her too often. It always happens, because Mistress wants it; Mistress **likes** punishment.

Lonnie slunk along behind Scorpia, a morbid part of her wondered if this was how Catra had always felt when she and Adora were called to Shadow Weaver's lair. All seething anger and fear. It probably was.

She'd already burned Adora, Lonnie wasn't sure how she was supposed to do that with Catra when she'd resigned herself to just never really knowing what had happened to her. Maybe the Princess she'd been carried off by would be able to save her.

Lonnie wanted her to, she'd never really recovered from losing her and Adora the first time. But she knew better than to let herself hope.

Where is she? Where is she? Where **is she?**

The ache is growing, louder and louder, echoing in her mind. They have the Sword, Catra must have fought them, she doesn't give up things that are hers without a fight.

Something went wrong; but Lonnie is with them, Lonnie knows her, Lonnie is Adora's friend. Her friends are Catra's friends, Lonnie wouldn't let them hurt- *"I don't know why you haven't given up on her. Catra just drags you down. Everybody knows it. She drags the whole team down."-*

Is Lonnie… not Catra's friend?

Lonnie wished she wasn't impressed by the harsh shadow that cloaks the Black Garnet chamber. Everything would be so much easier if watching Shadow Weaver melt out of the black didn't make her skin crawl so badly it itched.

She hated letting the bitch win so easily.

"Well?" Shadow Weaver prompted simply, offering a hand. It took everything Lonnie had not to flinch.

Scorpia jumps. It's dread, it can't be anything else. Catra should be here. Scorpia hands over the Sword and cool relief slices its way through Adora, it's so close, her other half will be hers soon.

The dread stays. "And the girl?"

"Catra." Lonnie blurts out and Mistress hesitates. It was her, it really was her. So then why isn't she here? "She's-" but why would she be here when Shadow Weaver is-

"I have a test for you, Adora. One last chance for you to prove your worth as my apprentice."

Adora stepped forward, forcing her feet to move despite the anxiety that made them feel like lead.

"Of course, what do I need to do?"

"Something so simple not even you could fail," she waved a hand dismissively and Adora tried not to let it sting. It was true, she'd failed every test and trial Shadow Weaver had ever put in front of her. "Stand here, in the center of the circle." She deserved whatever snide remarks were thrown her way.

She stood in the circle, and then-

Agony -

-the one who killed Adora.

"She's- she's dead. Jeff, he- uh- he stabbed her," Lonnie stammered out, nerve buckling under Shadow Weaver's stare. "Didn't survive doing it, but… yeah." Shadow Weaver let out a considering noise and turned back away from her.

Nonono- She's not dead, she can't be dead. Adora's the one who told them about the Sword, she's killed Catra- no, **NO-**
[INSTABILITY DETECTED: STABILIZING]

"She is three years late on that, then," the witch offered carelessly, "the child could not even die properly, it seems." The

atmosphere in the room changed all at once. Shadow Weaver's oppressive menace crushed under something that made Lonnie's bones rattle. "Oh well, at least we are finally rid of the brat."

Shadow Weaver turned, "you will stay, to bear witness." She lifted the sword, offering it to the Black Garnet. She didn't notice; how was Lonnie able to feel the difference, but the self-proclaimed "Greatest Sorceress of the Age" didn't react to the change?

How ***dare she-*** [ENCOURAGING AGGRESSION]

Shadow Weaver's darkness was a threat, a baton to the temple; stay the path, obey, and it wouldn't fire. Red light snapped around the Garnet, faster and faster, brighter and brighter. This? This was fury, straining violence that wasn't looking for an excuse, just an outlet.

The energy around the Black Garnet turned purple and Lonnie glanced over to Scorpia. Scorpia had the same nervous smile on as she did every time she had to deal with Shadow Weaver, she couldn't feel it either.

What *was* that?

[TARGET PARAMETERS SET: HORDE]

Something shifted inside the Garnet, a shadow at first, growing clearer as it moved across the faces of the Runestone. Lonnie's heart was pounding so loud that when Scorpia said something she couldn't hear it over the blood rushing in her ears.

A hand pressed against the inside of the Black Garnet, just like before, and Lonnie had to clutch onto Scorpia's offered claw to keep her knees from buckling. It felt like something had brushed against her side, burning and frozen at once, like it was trying to decide which of them in this room would make the best first target.

The hand pushed *though* and lost form, coiling out into the air in formless ribbons of shifting, prismatic light until some tendril of it brushed against the sword. The sword shot out of Shadow Weaver's hands fast enough that Lonnie heard a sharp intake of breath from the witch as she jerked back. Murky red splattered on the ground in front of her as the sword slammed into the floor, the tip sinking in.

Lonnie could tell Scorpia was saying something, fussing at her, but she couldn't hear it. Her eyes were locked on the shape still inside the Black Garnet, its hair was limp, not in her usual ponytail, but Lonnie could tell, she'd known for years now, could feel it like she was tugging on her *soul.*

"Adora?" She whispered. The figure didn't react, the lances of energy her arm had shredded into steadily coming together as she reached for the sword's handle. Slowly, haltingly, like every inch took a whole world of effort, until her hand had reformed, clenched tight around it, blue like her eyes had been.

[IMBALANCE DETECTED: COMPENSATING]

The Garnet *screeched* as Adora started to move, hauling herself out inch by painstaking inch with a sound like a live wire had been severed and dropped to arc lightning through burning oil. First a foot, shredding apart into light and coming back together until it was braced against the ground, then her head.

Even if it was barely more than a silhouette, watching Adora's head come apart like shrapnel made Lonnie feel sick to her stomach. Scorpia was rather loudly asking Shadow Weaver if she was sure this was safe, but Lonnie couldn't make out any of the words she was using to do it. Adora's face was more defined once it reformed, her eyes haunted even when cast entirely in blue light.

They stayed locked on the sword as she pulled the rest of herself through, taking one step, then another, and another, pulling on the sword like an anchor until all the shredded ribbons of light came together again, leaving her hunched over next to the sword. It still felt like there was something missing.

Lonnie had to look away when she realized that it was her breathing, she should have been panting after an effort like that; but Adora was dead, of course her ghost didn't breathe.

"Are you okay?" Scorpia murmured, eyes flicking between Lonnie and where Shadow Weaver was advancing towards Adora again.

"No," Lonnie choked out. She was shaking, leaning against Scorpia's arm like it was the only thing keeping her upright. All her joints from the waist down felt like they'd been pumped full of lubricant, it probably was.

[SYMBIOTIC MEASURE ESTABLISHED: BEGIN CORRECTION]

"Well done, Adora," Shadow Weaver cooed, like the thing standing in front of her wasn't pumping enough violence into the air to strangle someone with if it could just find a target.

And then it did. Lonnie looked back just in time to see the sword sling itself forward, dragging Adora's image behind it like a doll as it passed through Shadow Weaver's shoulder. Scorpia hauled Lonnie up off her feet before anything else could happen, scrambling back. The witch howled in pain, her darkness vanishing all at once as her arm hit the ground in a spurt of crimson darker even than her robe. She turned, clutching at her shoulder, and Adora straightened up, turning back to Shadow Weaver with the sword scraping along the floor, that same look on her face. Lonnie would almost call it blank if it wasn't so *pained.*

She *erupted.*

Whatever connection Lonnie had to whatever was happening snapped as power pulsed out from Adora with a scream like she was dying- privately, Lonnie was pretty sure it was the exact sound she'd made when Shadow Weaver killed her. Scorpia was

shoved off her feet, curling around Lonnie to shield her as her back hit the wall hard enough that Lonnie heard a crack.

Lonnie shook herself out of her stupor, without the haze of impending brutality pressing down on her mind her legs were listening to her again.

[HEART OF ETHERIA PROTOCOL, PHASE 0.5: IMPLEMENTATION SUCCESSFUL]

"We need to leave, *now,* " she hissed, pushing out of Scorpia's grip to try and haul her Captain back to her feet. She risked a glance back to where Shadow Weaver had been standing and froze.

Shadow Weaver's head was pinned under the blade of the sword, pressed almost to the hilt through her and into the floor, by a being that *almost* looked like Adora. It was too big, *way* too big, and for a flicker its arms were slender, elegant and smooth in a way Adora's body had never been before Lonnie blinked and it was as chiseled as Adora had ever dreamed of being. It was wrapped in armour, with a winged crown and a cape, all in that same eerie blue light.

It turned its head towards Lonnie- only its head, not an inch of the rest of it shifted from its position looming over Shadow Weaver's corpse, not even its neck- and Lonnie's breath caught in her chest. There was *nothing* in that stare anymore, *this* was what blank looked like, dead and still, just like the air was; Lonnie wasn't even sure it was really seeing her. Scorpia stood, leaning

on Lonnie a little for support now. Those blank eyes shifted to her and something sparked in them.

Lonnie didn't take the time to figure out what it could possibly be; no matter how Catra turned out, Lonnie was *not* losing another friend today. She stepped in front of Scorpia, too slow on the draw of her baton, but just quick enough that when the thing's hand would have slammed into Scorpia's chest, it grabbed Lonnie by the face instead.

Lonnie's neck strained and pain shot all down her back as she was hauled up off of her feet. Pressure smashed down on her skull hard enough that it made her dizzy, too disoriented to even scream. Scorpia screamed, but Lonnie was too busy realizing she was about to die to care.

Shit, this was it. She lashed out at the thing's elbow with her baton, set up as high as she could put it, but it just passed through like there was nothing there. Of course there was nothing there, it's Adora's *vengeful fucking ghost* and it's going to *crack Lonnie's head like an egg.*

She felt one of Scorpia's pincers take a hold of her torso and only the fact that Adora's hand was over her mouth kept her from calling her Captain an idiot. Adora wasn't even going to have to squeeze, Scorpia's panicked tugging was going to break Lonnie's neck for her.

The hand released just as Scorpia started pulling, and Lonnie ended up falling back into her hard enough that Scorpia stumbled,

her back hitting the wall again as she set Lonnie back on her feet and braced for a fight.

Adora's drowning, in grief, in rage, all her own this time; in the Sword, letting it steer her. Adora ruins everything she touches, spells, rituals, the Garnet, Shadow Weaver, **Catra-** Moons no, not Catra, not her, not her, **please-** but Lonnie is still her friend. She won't let the Sword hurt Lonnie.

The lights were back on in Adora's eyes, she looked *exhausted* all of the sudden, staring at Lonnie like she could recognize her again.

It passed and Adora stood up straight as an arrow, her face blank.

"Leave." She commanded in a voice that was Adora's and *not* at the same time, turning back towards the Garnet.

Lonnie grabbed Scorpia by the lapel and *ran.*

The alarms were blaring by the time she found Rogelio and Kyle, and when they got far enough away that Lonnie dared to look back, the whole Fright Zone was in flames.

End Notes

Come say hi at Makuta's Chronicle or genVicron!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!